



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Making India the destination for global sports goods production

The panel titled, 'Made in India - The Manufacturing Muscle', at the PlayCom 2025: Business of Sports Summit featured (from left to right) Vivek Kohli (Owner, Stag International) and Dr.

Kanishka Pandey (Faculty and Head-Centre for Sports Research, IMT Ghaziabad). The duo spoke about the importance of enhancing the sporting culture of the country and aiming to raise the demand and supply of quality Indian sporting goods not just in the country but across the world in a chat moderated by Mayank Goel (Partner, Trade, Customs & GST, KPMG India).

Pandey touched upon how the enhancement of sporting culture is connected to the rise in sports consumption. "More people

participating means more demand, and more demand means more manufacturing. That is why we need to actively promote sports culture."

But which is the best place to manufacture sports equipment?

"Factories should be set up near the ports. We should look at regions like Gujarat, Maharashtra or Chennai. Manufacturing near the port also helps boost exports," Kohli said, adding that it also reduces logistical costs drastically.

He also advocated for 'Made in

India' over 'Make in India'. "I would rather see Indian companies manufacture overseas than foreign companies manufacture in our country."

However, in the end, none of these optics will matter if children don't take up sport. Kohli said this is where schools come in. "They need to employ more sports teachers specialised in individual sports. It can be part of extra-curricular programmes. This will also create new sporting teaching jobs."

Pandey offered a quirky solution inspired by his organisation's Sports Literacy Mission, launched in 2017: "Instead of teaching the A for apple and B for ball, we should teach them A for athletics, B for basketball. Creating sporting awareness in this way can make a difference," he said.

